

OCBC Bank

Episodic GE 2Q26 profit surge on investment income;
trim OCBC on this strength

Great Eastern (GE) reported 2Q26 net income of S\$503mn, up 103% y/y and 45% q/q. OCBC's share of profits accounts for 26% of our 2Q26E OCBC forecast, higher vs. last quarter's 16% and the 15% average in the previous four quarters. This suggests ~10% upside to OCBC earnings in 2Q26. GE's growth in profits was led by strong investment performance, which led to shareholders' fund profits growing sharply q/q and y/y. Core business grew steadily, with TWNS up 2% q/q and 13% y/y, with q/q growth led by Malaysia. NBEV growth outpaced TWNS (+7% q/q, +25% y/y) driven by a more favorable product mix. This is a good beat for GE, with steady core helped by outsized investment profits; though the latter may not be sustainable. OCBC is up 33% in last 3M (vs. +15% for STI), trading at 17.4x/2.06x FY26 PE/PB for 12.2-12.4% 26E/27E RoE. Factor rotation to Financials and Singapore has helped the current phase of performance, which appears to have taken the stock meaningfully above fair multiples. Accordingly, we recommend trimming. GE-led EPS revisions are likely going to be small on a full-year basis, as investment gains tend to be episodic.

Underweight

OCBC.SI, OCBC.SP

Price (30 Jul 26): S\$29.10

Price Target (Jun-27): S\$20.00

APAC Banks

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Table 1: GE: 2Q26 Earnings Snapshot

S\$mn	2Q26	1Q26	4Q25	3Q25	2Q25	QoQ	YoY
Total Weighted New Sales	411.3	401.9	453.7	373.1	363.5	2%	13%
New Business Embedded Value	209.9	195.4	241.0	182.2	167.7	7%	25%
Profit from Insurance Business	286.3	329.0	172.2	228.8	168.4	-13%	70%
Profit from Shareholders' Fund	216.9	17.3	69.2	143.2	79.8	1154%	172%
Profit Attributable to Shareholders	503.2	346.3	241.4	372.0	248.2	45%	103%

Source: Company data.

Table 2: GE: New Business Embedded Value (NBEV) by market

S\$ millions	2Q26	1Q26	4Q25	3Q25	2Q25	QoQ	YoY
Singapore	108	118	112	102	67	-8%	62%
Malaysia	98	75	127	77	99	31%	0%
Emerging Markets	3	3	3	3	2	14%	43%
Total	210	195	241	182	168	7%	25%

Source: Company data.

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Table 3: GE: Total Weighted New Sales (TWNS) by market

<i>\$ millions</i>	2Q26	1Q26	4Q25	3Q25	2Q25	QoQ	YoY
SINGAPORE							
Agency	142	128	151	117	92	11%	54%
Banca	112	119	101	124	119	-6%	-6%
Others	16	20	7	11	19	-23%	-16%
<i>Total Weighted New Sales</i>	269	267	259	252	230	1%	17%
MALAYSIA							
Agency	121	94	171	102	113	29%	8%
Banca	4	4	9	6	5	17%	-19%
Others	8	29	6	6	9	-73%	-16%
<i>Total Weighted New Sales</i>	133	127	186	113	127	5%	5%
OTHER ASIA							
<i>Total Weighted New Sales</i>	9	8	9	8	7	4%	32%
TOTAL							
<i>Total Weighted New Sales</i>	411	402	454	373	364	2%	13%

Source: Company data.

Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

OCBC Bank *(Underweight; Price Target: S\$20.00)*

Investment Thesis

We are UW on OCBC.

- The bank has built a multi-brand financial conglomerate in Asia, with Wing Hang, BoS, GEH and Bank of Ningbo the main acquisitions/stake increases in the last 20 years, with Lion Global a product of the merger between OCBC/GEH AMs. The group is generating a 1.08% RoA with ~11x leverage in 2026E.
- The track record suggests OCBC is more likely to use excess capital to buy, rather than increase payout significantly. While management is committed to the current S\$2.5bn capital return plan, visibility for further increases in payout is low in 2026. Further, the bank's track record on inorganic growth could lead to near-term risks if growth is via inorganic means and transactions are not immediately accretive.
- We expect S\$1 DPS in 2026. This assumes a 50% regular payout, as well as the payout of the remaining S\$780mn as special dividend. Beyond FY26, we expect the bank to sustain its total payout close to 60%.
- The bank is benefitting from significant inflows of funds into Singapore and in SGD. This should support NII, though a reduction in credit spreads is a risk, given macro uncertainties. We expect a 1.74% NIM in FY26 vs. 1.91% in FY25.
- Risk/reward has turned negative following the stock price strength. The stock currently trades at a 2x 2026E P/B for a ~12% ROE, while concerns about a WM fee slowdown could be a catalyst for stock price weakness following China's policy announcement on ODI.

Valuation

Our Jun-27 PT of S\$20 is based on a fair P/B of 1.34x, assuming a normalized RoE of 12.2%, a risk-free rate of 4.1%, a cost of capital of 10.2% and a growth rate of 4.3%.

Risks to Rating and Price Target

Upside risks include a significant improvement in DPS, a meaningfully value-accretive deal, better than-expected growth at GE, and better-than-expected WM fees. Bank of Ningbo (20%-owned by OCBC) has competitive advantages in local SMEs and high-net-worth retail clients, which could drive faster growth at the group.

Downside risks include weaker-than-expected NIMs, a significant slowdown in NNM, market share losses in wealth management, a lack of increases in capital return, and M&A, if transactions are not immediately accretive.

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OCBC Bank (OCBC.SI, OCBC SP) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (\$)	Price Target (\$)
13-Mar-24	UW	13.09	12.5
10-May-24	NR	13.91	--
13-Jul-25	N	16.89	18
08-Aug-25	N	17.09	17.5
10-Sep-25	N	16.76	17
28-Nov-25	OW	18.27	20
09-Jan-26	N	20.17	20.5
03-Apr-26	UW	22.38	20

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
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